

Guest Enquiry & Soft-Link System

Product Requirements & Flow Document

Proptii Communication / Messaging

1. Overview

This document defines the requirements and end-to-end flow for capturing guest (unauthenticated) user details on the property listing platform.

- Collect the guest’s contact details via a Quick Request modal.
- Create a temporary “soft” account (ghost account) for both the enquiring tenant and the receiving landlord if neither is registered.
- Enable threaded email-based messaging between both parties without requiring sign-up.
- Trigger account-claim emails to both parties once a reply is exchanged, inviting them to register and retain their conversation history.

2. Actors & Definitions

Actor	Definition
Guest Tenant	An unauthenticated user browsing properties. Has not registered an account.
Ghost Tenant	A system-generated soft account created when a guest tenant submits an enquiry. Identified by email only.
Platform Landlord	A registered landlord who owns listings on the platform.
External Landlord	A landlord whose listing was scraped from OnTheMove or RightMarket. Not registered on the platform.
Ghost Landlord	A system-generated soft account representing an external landlord. Created when a tenant enquires about a scraped listing.
Claimed Account	A ghost account (tenant or landlord) that has been converted into a full registered account after following the claim email link.

3. Quick Request Modal — UI Specification

3.1 Updated Modal Design

Field / Component	Specification
-------------------	---------------

Modal Title	Send a Quick Request
Subtitle	Tell us what you need and we'll get right back to you.
Category Selector	Pill-style multi-select: Book Viewing Property Price Availability Mortgage Info Neighbourhood Info Other
Your Message	Textarea, placeholder: "Tell us more about what you're looking for...". Min 10 chars, max 1000 chars.
Reply Channel	Email only.
Your Email Address	Email input with validation. Helper text: "The email you provide is the one we'll use to reach you. Make sure it's correct."
Your Name (new)	Optional text input. Used to personalise replies.
Primary CTA	"Send Request" — filled orange (#D95B00). Disabled until email + message are valid.
Secondary CTA	"Sign Up" — outlined orange. Opens standard registration flow.
GDPR Notice	Checkbox: "I agree to be contacted about this property. View Privacy Policy." Required before Send.

3.2 Trigger Conditions

- Guest clicks "Contact Landlord" or "Book Viewing" on any listing card or listing detail page.
- Guest attempts to send a message or enquiry while unauthenticated.
- Modal is also triggered if a guest clicks reply in a notification email without being logged in.

4. Ghost Account (Soft Link) Creation

4.1 Ghost Tenant Account

When a guest submits the Quick Request form, the system checks whether an account exists for the provided email address.

Condition	Action
Email does not exist	Create ghost_tenant record. Set status = 'ghost', source = 'quick_request', created_at = now.
Email exists (full account)	Attach enquiry to existing account. Prompt user to log in for full conversation access.
Email exists (ghost)	Reuse ghost account. Append new enquiry thread. Do not create a duplicate.

4.2 Ghost Landlord Account (Scraped Listings)

For listings sourced from OnTheMove or RightMarket, the original landlord is not on the platform. A ghost landlord account is created to hold the enquiry thread.

- Ghost landlord is identified by the scraped contact email or phone (if available from the listing source).
- If no contact detail is available, the enquiry is queued and the system marks the listing as “enquiry pending”.
- Ghost landlord record stores: `source_platform` (e.g. “onthemove”), `external_listing_id`, `scraped_contact_email` (nullable), `status` = ‘ghost’.
- The platform may forward the message to the scraped contact email on behalf of the guest.

4.3 Ghost Account Data Model

Field	Type	Notes
id	UUID	Primary key
email	string	Unique. Required for tenants. Optional for ghost landlords.
name	string null	From form input or scraped listing
role	enum	ghost_tenant ghost_landlord
status	enum	ghost claim_email_sent claimed
source_platform	string null	null onthemove rightmarket direct
claim_token	string null	Secure random token. Expires in 30 days.
claim_token_expires_at	datetime null	Set when claim email is dispatched
claimed_at	datetime null	Set when account is fully claimed
created_at	datetime	Timestamp of ghost account creation

5. Messaging Thread — Guest Conversation Flow

5.1 Thread Creation

1. Guest submits Quick Request. Ghost tenant account is created (or matched).
2. System creates an `enquiry_thread` record linked to: `ghost_tenant_id`, `listing_id`, `landlord_id` (platform or ghost).
3. A unique `thread_token` is generated for tokenised email replies.
4. The enquiry message is stored as the first message in the thread.

5.2 Email Relay Mechanism

All messages between ghost users are relayed via the platform's email relay system. This enables a conversation without either party needing to log in.

- Each thread has a unique relay address: `reply+{thread_token}@mail.yourplatform.com`
- When a landlord replies (by email), the platform parses the inbound email, extracts the reply body, strips quoted history, and appends it to the thread.
- The tenant receives a notification email with the reply embedded and a “Reply” button linking back to a tokenised reply page.
- The tenant can reply via the tokenised web page or directly by replying to the notification email.
- A maximum thread depth of 20 messages is enforced for ghost threads. Beyond this, users must claim accounts.

5.3 Enquiry Thread Data Model

Field	Type	Notes
id	UUID	Primary key
listing_id	UUID	Reference to listing (internal or scraped)
ghost_tenant_id	UUID	FK to ghost_accounts
landlord_id	UUID	FK to users or ghost_accounts
thread_token	string	Unique token for email relay. Never expires.
relay_email	string	<code>reply+{thread_token}@mail.yourplatform.com</code>
category	string[]	Categories selected in modal
status	enum	open replied closed archived
created_at	datetime	

6. Email Notification & Claim Flows

6.1 Email Flow A — Guest Submits Enquiry

#	Recipient	Email Content
1	Ghost Tenant	Confirmation: “Your enquiry has been sent.” Thread summary, reply link, Sign Up CTA.
2	Platform Landlord (if registered)	New enquiry notification. Tenant message, reply button, link to listing.
3	External Landlord (if scraped email available)	Forwarded enquiry with platform branding. Reply-to set to relay address.

6.2 Email Flow B — Reply Received (Claim Trigger)

When any reply is recorded on a thread involving a ghost account, the claim email sequence is triggered.

5. System detects first reply on thread.
6. For each ghost party (tenant and/or landlord):
 - Generate secure claim_token (UUID v4, 32 bytes).
 - Set claim_token_expires_at = now + 30 days.
 - Set status = 'claim_email_sent'.
 - Dispatch claim email (see template below).
7. Reply notification email is also sent with the new message content.

6.3 Claim Email Template (Tenant)

Element	Content
Subject	You have a reply — claim your account to keep the conversation
Headline	Someone replied to your property enquiry!
Body	You sent an enquiry about [Property Address]. [Landlord/Agent Name] has replied. Claim your free account to view the full conversation, save properties, and manage your viewings.
Primary CTA	Claim My Account — links to /claim?token={claim_token}
Secondary CTA	View Reply Without Signing Up — tokenised thread page
Footer	Expiry notice: “This link expires in 30 days.” Unsubscribe link. Privacy Policy.

6.4 Claim Email Template (Landlord — External / Ghost)

Element	Content
Subject	A tenant enquired about your property — list it free on [Platform Name]
Headline	Someone is interested in your property!
Body	A prospective tenant has sent an enquiry about your listing at [Property Address] which we found on [Source Platform]. Claim your free landlord account to manage enquiries, respond directly, and list more properties.
Primary CTA	Claim My Landlord Account — /claim?token={claim_token}&role=landlord
Secondary CTA	View & Reply to Enquiry — tokenised reply page
Footer	Unsubscribe Privacy Policy “Your listing was found on [Source Platform].”

7. Account Claim Flow

7.1 Claim Page (/claim?token=...)

8. User lands on claim page via email link.
9. System validates token: exists, not expired, status = 'claim_email_sent'.
10. Pre-fill registration form with known data (email, name if available).
11. User sets password (or continues via Google/Facebook/Twitter).
12. On successful registration:
 - ghost_account.status = 'claimed', claimed_at = now.
 - ghost_account.claim_token = null (invalidated).
 - Link full user account to all historical threads.
 - All past messages and enquiries are migrated to the new account.
13. User is redirected to their inbox/conversation dashboard.

7.2 Token Expiry Handling

- If claim_token is expired: show message "This link has expired" + button to request a new one.
- Re-send endpoint: POST /claim/resend — accepts email, issues new token if ghost account exists.
- Ghost accounts with status = 'ghost' (no reply received) do not receive claim emails proactively.

7.3 Merged Account Rules

- If a user registers with an email that matches a ghost account, auto-merge on email verification.
- All ghost threads are reassigned to the full account.
- Ghost account record is soft-deleted (retained for audit; not surfaced in UI).

8. End-to-End Flow Summary

#	Event	Tenant State	Landlord State
1	Guest searches for property	Unauthenticated	Platform / External
2	Guest opens Quick Request modal and submits enquiry	Ghost Tenant created	Ghost Landlord created (if scraped)
3	Confirmation email sent to tenant; enquiry forwarded to landlord	Awaiting reply	Receives forwarded enquiry
4	Landlord replies via email or platform	Notified by email	Reply recorded on thread
5	Claim email triggered for all ghost parties	Claim email sent	Claim email sent
6	Tenant can reply via tokenised web page or email	Active on thread	Notified of tenant reply

7	Either party clicks claim link and registers	Full Account	Full Account
8	All historical messages migrated to registered accounts	Inbox with history	Dashboard with history

9. Scraped Listing Handling — OnTheMove & RightMarket

9.1 Listing Metadata

- Each scraped listing stores: source_platform, external_listing_id, external_url, scraped_at, landlord_contact_email (if parseable).
- Listings are tagged with a “Source” badge on the UI (e.g. “Via OnTheMove”) for transparency.
- Scraping cadence: minimum every 24 hours. Removed external listings are flagged as ‘expired’.

9.2 Enquiry Routing for Scraped Listings

- If landlord_contact_email is available: relay enquiry to that address using platform relay email.
- If landlord_contact_email is not available: store enquiry in pending state. Notify internal team to manually trace contact.
- Platform clearly communicates to the tenant: “This listing is from an external source. We’ve forwarded your enquiry and will update you.”

9.3 Compliance Considerations

- All scraped listing enquiries must include opt-out / unsubscribe links in forwarded emails.
- External landlords must be given the option to remove their listing from the platform in claim emails.
- Data from scraped listings must not be used for marketing without explicit consent.

10. Functional Requirements Summary

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-01	Quick Request modal with Email-only reply channel (WhatsApp removed)	Must Have
FR-02	Ghost tenant account creation on form submission	Must Have
FR-03	Ghost landlord account creation for scraped listings	Must Have
FR-04	Email relay system with unique thread tokens	Must Have
FR-05	Tokenised reply page for guests (no login required)	Must Have
FR-06	Claim email triggered on first reply for ghost parties	Must Have
FR-07	Account claim page with token validation and registration	Must Have

FR-08	Migration of ghost thread history to claimed account	Must Have
FR-09	Duplicate ghost account prevention (match by email)	Should Have
FR-10	Claim token expiry and re-issue endpoint	Should Have
FR-11	External landlord opt-out / listing removal from claim email	Should Have
FR-12	Thread depth limit (20 messages) for ghost threads	Nice to Have
FR-13	Source badge on scraped listings (e.g. "Via OnTheMove")	Nice to Have